

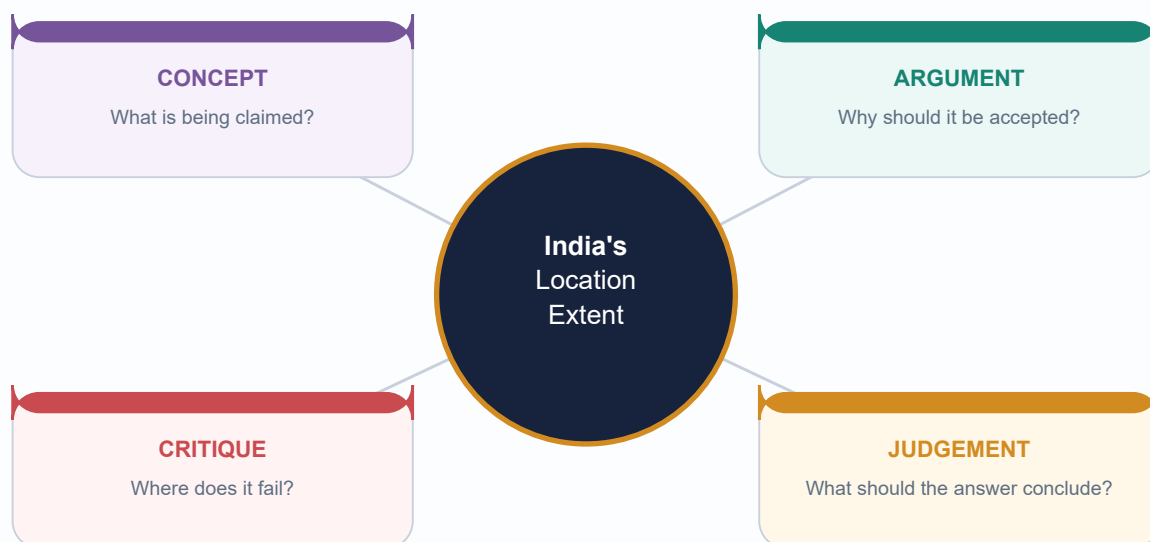
UPSC GEOGRAPHY SOLVED WORKBOOK

India's Location and Extent - Solved Practice Workbook

Geography 01 | GS-I + Prelims

Rebuilt 15 August 2026

[FACT] verified | [ANALYSIS] reasoned synthesis | [LIMIT] scope/status caution



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

1. Verified PYQ - UPSC GS-I 2021

GS-I Geography

STATIC THEORY

- PYQ - UPSC GS-I 2021: Why is India considered as a subcontinent? Elaborate your answer. (10 marks, 150 words)

- **Model answer (10 marks/150 words).** [CLAIM] India is considered a subcontinent because it combines continental scale with a relatively coherent physical frame inside Asia. [EVIDENCE] Its approximately 3.28 million sq km area, Himalayan arc, Indo-Gangetic-Brahmaputra plains, peninsular plateau, long coast and island extensions form a large, internally connected geographic unit. [MECHANISM] The Himalaya and surrounding seas provide relative enclosure; monsoon circulation, major river systems and the peninsula create shared environmental linkages, while scale produces striking climatic, ecological and cultural diversity. [EVIDENCE] Passes across the north-west and north-east and Arabian Sea-Bay of Bengal routes connected the region with Central Asia, West Asia, Africa and South-East Asia. [LIMIT] Therefore enclosure never meant isolation, nor does subcontinent imply homogeneity. The term is best understood as a large and distinctive subdivision of Asia whose physical coherence coexists with porous frontiers and deep internal diversity. **Why this earns marks:** it answers 'why', uses named spatial evidence, explains mechanism, qualifies isolation and closes with a graded definition.

- Outstanding-answer checklist: define subcontinent relationally; use scale, enclosure, internal coherence/diversity and permeability; avoid a country-list answer.

MAINS ANGLE

Direct routed owner PYQ; extracted from the local official paper.

STUDY LINK

Local source: [books/more_previous_papers/QP-CSM-21-GENSTUDIESPAPER-I-110122.pdf](#)

HIGH

2. Original conceptual and map MCQs

Prelims GS-I
Geography

ELIMINATION GRID

COORDINATE CLOSE-OPTION ELIMINATION GRID

SCHEMATIC - NOT TO SCALE

Latitude	N/S of Equator	India: N
Longitude	E/W of Greenwich	India: E
Tropic	23°30'N	8 states
IST	82°30'E	UTC+5:30
Mainland south	8°4'N	not Indira Point
Territory south	about 6°45'N	Nicobar chain

*Every option should be tested by category, range, order or arithmetic.**Original study visual.*

STATIC THEORY

- Q1. India lies wholly in which hemispheres? A) Northern and Eastern B) Northern and Western C) Southern and Eastern D) Southern and Western **Answer: A.** Both the mainland and islands lie north of the Equator and east of Greenwich.
- Q2. Which statement correctly distinguishes mainland and territorial south? A) Indira Point is mainland south B) Kanyakumari is mainland south; Indira Point is territorial south C) Both are on the mainland D) Kanyakumari is territorial south only **Answer: B.** Kanyakumari and Indira Point answer different spatial categories.
- Q3. The Tropic of Cancer states begin west-to-east with: A) Rajasthan, Gujarat B) Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat C) Gujarat, Rajasthan D) Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh **Answer: C.** The correct opening is Gujarat then Rajasthan.
- Q4. IST is UTC+5:30 because: A) India uses 75 deg E B) 82.5 deg divided by 4 gives hours C) India is 5.5 deg east D) 82.5 deg x 4 minutes = 330 minutes **Answer: D.** Longitude is converted at four minutes per degree.
- Q5. The mainland latitudinal envelope begins near: A) 8 deg 4'N B) 6 deg 45'N C) 23 deg 30'N D) 37 deg 6'N **Answer: A.** 6 deg 45'N belongs to the southern island extension.
- Q6. Which is the correct west-east Tropic sequence fragment? A) Jharkhand-Chhattisgarh-West Bengal B) Chhattisgarh-Jharkhand-West Bengal C) West Bengal-Jharkhand-Tripura D) Madhya Pradesh-Rajasthan-Chhattisgarh **Answer: B.** The central-east sequence is Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal.
- Q7. Why are the N-S and E-W linear distances unequal despite similar angular spans? A) Latitude circles shrink northward B) Earth rotates unevenly C) Meridians converge poleward D) The Tropic bends **Answer: C.** Longitude-degree length varies with latitude.
- Q8. Which conclusion follows from the 2025 coastline revision? A) India gained land B) CRZ boundaries automatically moved C) India's area increased D) Finer methodology captured more coastal detail **Answer: D.** The revision is methodological, not territorial.

- Q9. India's official land-neighbour list contains: A) Seven countries B) Five countries C) Nine countries including islands D) Only six accessible crossings **Answer: A.** The official list includes Afghanistan under India's map claim.
- Q10. Sri Lanka is separated from India principally by: A) Ten Degree Channel B) Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar C) Eight Degree Channel D) Andaman Sea **Answer: B.** These shallow maritime features separate Tamil Nadu and Sri Lanka.
- Q11. Which water body lies east of the Andaman-Nicobar chain? A) Arabian Sea B) Gulf of Kachchh C) Andaman Sea D) Gulf of Mannar **Answer: C.** The Andaman Sea is east of the island arc.
- Q12. A sound subcontinent answer should NOT claim: A) continental scale B) relative enclosure C) internal diversity D) complete historical isolation **Answer: D.** Passes and seas enabled continuous interaction.
- Q13. Which term means relationship to routes and surrounding regions? A) Situation B) Site C) Extent D) Latitude **Answer: A.** Situation is relational; site is the ground occupied.
- Q14. A city at 97 deg E is locally solar-time ahead of one at 68 deg E by about: A) 29 minutes B) 116 minutes C) 240 minutes D) 330 minutes **Answer: B.** 29 deg x four minutes is about 116 minutes.
- Q15. Which is the strongest bounded statement? A) India controls Malacca B) The Himalaya is impenetrable C) India is affected by routes through Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb and Malacca D) All islands are naval assets only **Answer: C.** Route relevance does not equal control.
- Q16. Which pairing is incorrect? A) Lakshadweep-Arabian Sea B) Andaman-Nicobar-eastern maritime flank C) Kanyakumari-mainland south D) Indira Point-mainland south **Answer: D.** Indira Point is territorial south.

MAINS ANGLE

Keys rotate strictly A-B-C-D throughout.

STUDY LINK

All questions are original; none is represented as a UPSC PYQ.

HIGH

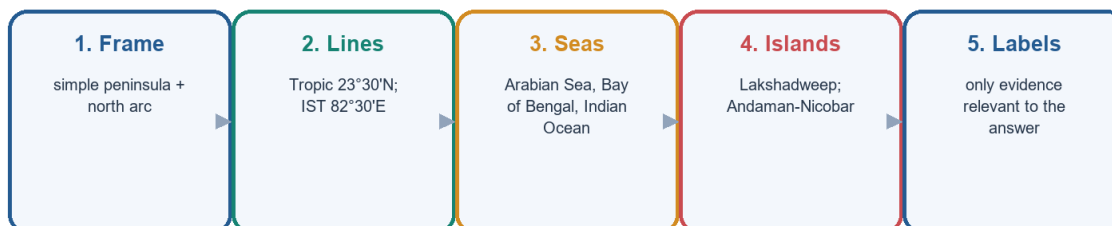
3. Remedial calculations and map labels

Prelims + GS-I
Geography

MAP SEQUENCE

30-SECOND INDIA LOCATION MAP SEQUENCE

SCHEMATIC - NOT TO SCALE



A clean schematic earns more than a crowded pseudo-precise map.

Draw only what the answer needs.

Original study visual.

STATIC THEORY

- **Calculation 1:** $97^\circ 25'E - 68^\circ 7'E = 29^\circ 18'$. At four minutes per degree: 117 minutes 12 seconds, conventionally about two hours.
- **Calculation 2:** $82^\circ 30'E = 82.5^\circ$. $82.5/15 = 5.5$ hours = UTC+5:30.
- **Calculation 3:** Mid-longitude of mainland envelope = $(68^\circ 7' + 97^\circ 25')/2 = \text{about } 82^\circ 46'E$. Therefore $82^\circ 30'E$ is near-central, not mathematically exact.
- **Map exercise:** mark Tropic of Cancer, $82^\circ 30'E$, Arabian Sea, Bay of Bengal, Indian Ocean, Lakshadweep and Andaman-Nicobar. Solution: Tropic horizontal through broad middle; meridian north-south near central India; islands placed west and south-east respectively.
- **Remedial rule:** if a place-name option is ambiguous, prefer the verified coordinate/category statement over an unqualified inhabited-village label.

MAINS ANGLE

Show arithmetic units and who is ahead; label maps schematic/not to scale.

STUDY LINK

Return to sections 3-6 of the main package.

HIGH

4. Solved original Mains practice

GS-I Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Original 10-marker: Explain why India's similar latitudinal and longitudinal spans produce unequal north-south and east-west distances.

- **Model answer.** [CLAIM] Angular equality on a globe does not produce equal linear distance because latitude and longitude are geometrically different. [EVIDENCE] Mainland India spans about 29 deg 02' in latitude and 29 deg 18' in longitude, but about 3,214 km north-south and 2,933 km east-west. [MECHANISM] One degree of latitude remains nearly constant, whereas meridians converge poleward, so a longitude degree equals roughly 111 km multiplied by cosine latitude. India's east-west span therefore traverses shorter longitude degrees than at the Equator. [LIMIT] Published distances also follow the country's irregular outline rather than a perfect rectangle. [VERDICT] Coordinate span must be converted using spherical geometry, not read as a flat grid. **Why this earns marks:** exact figures serve a mechanism, with a shape qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Scale named evidence to marks; do not pad with unrelated physiography.

STUDY LINK

Answer-writing spine:
claim-evidence-mechanism-limit-verdict.

HIGH

5. Solved original Mains practice

GS-I Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Original 15-marker: Analyse how India's location has shaped climate, cultural contacts and maritime strategy.

- **Model answer.** [CLAIM] India's location supplies an enabling physical and relational frame, but outcomes arise through circulation, routes and state capacity. [EVIDENCE] Tropical-subtropical latitude, the Himalayan arc and Arabian Sea-Bay of Bengal moisture combine with monsoon circulation to produce seasonal rainfall and regional contrasts. [MECHANISM] The Himalaya filters cold air and forces uplift, while the ocean moderates coasts; however relief and circulation, not latitude alone, explain rainfall. [EVIDENCE] North-western passes, Himalayan valleys and long coasts connected India with Central Asia, West Asia, East Africa and South-East Asia, enabling multidirectional movement of crops, faiths, technologies and communities. [EVIDENCE] The peninsula and island chains place India near northern Indian Ocean routes linking Gulf/Red Sea approaches with South-East Asia. [MECHANISM] This supports ports, energy security, maritime awareness and disaster response. [LIMIT] India does not automatically control Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb or Malacca, and strategic use must respect island ecology and communities. [VERDICT] Location is strategic potential converted into outcomes by infrastructure, institutions and cooperation. **Why this earns marks:** three dimensions, named evidence, mechanisms and anti-determinist qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Scale named evidence to marks; do not pad with unrelated physiography.

STUDY LINK

Answer-writing spine:
claim-evidence-mechanism-limit-verdict.

HIGH

6. Solved original Mains practice

GS-I Geography

STATIC THEORY

- Original 20-marker: 'The Himalaya and the Indian Ocean have made India both a relatively coherent geographic unit and an open arena of exchange.' Discuss.

- **Model answer.** [CLAIM] The apparent contradiction is the core of India's situation: mountain-ocean enclosure creates relative coherence, while selective gateways sustain exchange. [EVIDENCE] The Himalayan-Karakoram arc separates the subcontinent from the Tibetan and Central Asian interiors, checks cold continental air and helps organise river and monsoon systems. [MECHANISM] This gives the northern plains and peninsula a shared environmental frame. [LIMIT] Yet passes and valleys were never sealed; they carried trade, pilgrimage, pastoral mobility and political contact. [EVIDENCE] To the south, the peninsula is flanked by the Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal and extended by Lakshadweep and Andaman-Nicobar. [MECHANISM] Cheap maritime movement connected western India to Gulf-East African circuits and eastern India to Sri Lanka and South-East Asia; monsoon winds historically structured sailing seasons. [EVIDENCE] Modern shipping links West Asian energy routes with East Asian production networks through the wider Indian Ocean. [LIMIT] External chokepoints remain beyond Indian sovereignty, while coasts and islands face cyclones, tsunamis, erosion and ecological limits. [ANALYSIS] Thus mountains and seas are filters and connectors, not deterministic walls or highways. [VERDICT] India's geographic unity is relative and relational: enclosure supplies a recognisable subcontinental frame, but permeability explains its plural culture and maritime significance. **Why this earns marks:** the answer directly resolves the quotation, scales evidence to 20 marks and balances unity with permeability.

MAINS ANGLE

Scale named evidence to marks; do not pad with unrelated physiography.

STUDY LINK

Answer-writing spine:
claim-evidence-mechanism-limit-verdict.

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI